SYLPH

A FREE GUIDE



FOR FURNITURE, LIGHTING AND DECOR BRANDS

The Brand Architects Remember

7 things editors look for before they feature a brand. And how to get yours remembered by the people who choose what goes into India's finest homes.

FROM THE EDITORS OF SYLPH · WITH A NOTE FROM PRERNA PANDEY, FOUNDER

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Mia Cara by Meher Sethi, from its Sylph cover story.

WHO THIS IS FOR

Furniture, lighting, decor and surface brands with a finished collection, who want architects and homeowners to know them by name, not by discount.



Prerna Pandey, Founder of Sylph, with the ANCA edition at Wat Chalong Temple, Thailand.

A NOTE FROM THE FOUNDER

Most brands send a catalogue. Architects remember a story.

Every edition, brands write to us with a price list and a folder of photographs on white backgrounds.

Beautiful products. Nothing to remember them by.

The brands that stay in an architect's mind do something different. They tell us who makes their pieces, from what, and for which homes. They show their work in real rooms. They put a face to the name.

This guide is what I wish every brand knew before writing to a magazine. Read it before your next shoot, and before your next collection.

Prerna Pandey

FOUNDER, SYLPH

INTRODUCTION

Why good brands stay invisible

Picture an architect choosing the lights for a family's new home. She is flipping through the magazine on their coffee table, stops at your chandelier, and says: "This one."

That is what a feature does. Your brand is seen by the homeowner and by the architect who chooses, in the same room, at the same moment.

But most brands never get there. They send catalogues. They talk discounts. They put everything into one exhibition stall that is packed up on Monday.

The good news: a brand worth remembering is not about the size of your ad budget. It is about giving an editor a story worth telling.

In this guide you will discover:

- ✓ The 7 things editors look for before they feature a brand
- ✓ The shot list that shows your pieces at their best
- ✓ The 5 mistakes that keep good brands out
- ✓ How to write your brand in 150 words
- ✓ A one-page checklist to run before you send anything



The founders of Lumiere by Imperial in their showroom, from their Sylph cover story.

48	EDITIONS A YEAR, FOUR A MONTH
60,000+	COPIES A YEAR, HAND-DELIVERED TO UHNI AND HNI HOMES
4	COVERS A MONTH, ONE PER EDITION
7,000+	BRANDS AND STUDIOS SINCE 2021



PART ONE

7 things editors look for in a brand

Editors do not feature products. They feature the story behind them: the maker, the material, and the home where the piece belongs.

1

A story behind the piece

Every piece worth featuring has a story. Who makes it. What it is made from. How long one takes. Why it exists at all.

Start with that, not with the specifications. An editor can find the dimensions on your website. What they cannot find is the reason someone should care.



FROM THE PAGES

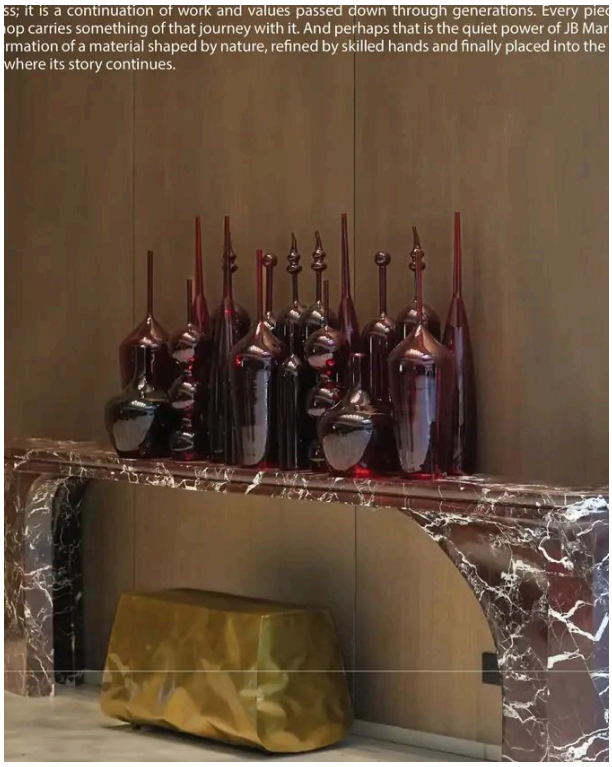
Argmac's feature told the story of custom pool, foosball and table tennis tables made for the leisure rooms of ultra-luxury homes, private villas and clubs, in India and abroad, including Dubai.

2

One signature piece

Do not send the whole catalogue. Choose the one piece people will remember, and lead with it.

The rest of the collection can follow. But the opening image of your feature should be the piece an architect will picture when she hears your name.



FROM THE PAGES

JB Marble Decor's feature opened with marble fireplaces and sculpted furniture, shaped and finished by hand. One material, told well.

3

Materials and craft, up close

Luxury buyers want to know why a piece costs what it costs. The answer is almost always in the material and the hands that worked it.

Show the grain, the weave, the stitch, the finish. Show the workshop. Then tell the editor where the material comes from and how long the work takes.



D'Vinity by Kavita Chopra, a luxury bedding brand, from its Sylph feature.

4

The people behind the brand

Architects buy from people they trust. A founder's face and story make a brand feel personal, not like a supplier.

Have a good portrait ready: the founder, or the founding team, in the showroom or the workshop.



All three founders of Triveni The Granite Studio, on the cover of Sylph.

FROM THE PAGES

Lumiere by Imperial's cover put its founders, Ayush Gupta and Tanuj Gupta, front and centre, with a feature on their lighting inside.

5

Photographs that show your pieces at their best

You need 15 to 25 strong photographs, not your full catalogue. Brief your photographer with this list.

The hero	Your signature piece in a finished, beautiful room. This often decides the opening page.
In real rooms	Three or four pieces shown in homes or projects, the way they will be lived with.
The details	Four to six close-ups: the joint, the finish, the stitch, the hardware.
The material	Two or three tight shots of the raw material itself: the slab, the timber, the fabric.
The making	One or two photographs of hands at work in the workshop.
The collection	One photograph of the collection together, styled with care.
The portrait	The founder, in the showroom or the workshop. Relaxed and well lit.



A JB Marble Decor table, from its Sylph feature.

BEFORE YOU SEND

- ✓ Send the original files. Images forwarded on WhatsApp lose detail and do not print well.
- ✓ Shoot your hero piece both upright and sideways. Pages are upright. Spreads are wide.
- ✓ Keep colours true to the real piece. Buyers will compare.

6

The architects you work with

Editors love the connection between a brand and the people who specify it. So do readers.

If a well-known studio has used your pieces in a home, say so, with their permission. A photograph of your piece in their project is worth more than a hundred product shots.

Every Sylph edition features architects and designers, so your brand sits on the same pages as the people who choose.



Mia Cara decor, from its Sylph feature.

7

The right moment

Print works on a calendar. Sylph publishes four editions a month, and booked places run first come, first served.

Time your feature to a new collection, a showroom opening or the months before a big trade fair, so architects see you before they plan their next projects.

Plan backwards. Material in by the middle of a month usually runs the month after, and the edition closest to your launch may already be full.



Inside Triveni The Granite Studio, from its Sylph feature.

PART TWO

5 mistakes that keep good brands out

None of these are about talent. All of them are easy to fix once you know.

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1 Sending the catalogue

Two hundred products and a price list give the editor nothing to write about. Choose one collection and one story.

2 Only white backgrounds

A product shot tells an architect what a piece looks like. A room tells her how it feels. Show your pieces in finished spaces.

3 Talking discounts

Sale language cheapens a luxury brand. Tell readers why a piece costs what it costs, not how much they can save.

4 Paying an agent for a page

Many magazine pages are sold through agents. A page that costs ₹3 lakh can be sold to you for ₹4.5 lakh, with ₹1.5 lakh kept as the agent's cut. Ask the magazine directly for its fixed price.

5 Betting everything on one exhibition

A stall is busy for four days, then it is packed up. A magazine stays on a coffee table, and in an architect's memory, for much longer.

PART THREE

3 things few brands are told

NOTE 1

Architects pick the brand they remember

Not always the best one. The one they remember, because they keep seeing it in the right places. A feature in a magazine on a client's coffee table is one of those places.

NOTE 2

A feature keeps working long after the edition

Show the pages to the architects you work with, put them in your showroom, and add them to your website. Some brands display their Sylph feature on their own site.

NOTE 3

You sit next to the people who choose

Every edition features the architects and designers who furnish UHNI homes. Your brand is on the same pages, read by their clients.



Sanidhya Jain of Progetto, on the cover of Sylph.

> "Having our work published with an editor's voice gave our firm the exact third-person authority we needed to close our largest UHNI project to date."
>
> A SYLPH CLIENT

USE THIS BEFORE YOU SEND ANYTHING

The brand checklist

Tick every line, and you are ready for an editor. Miss a few, and you know exactly what to fix.

- [ ] I can say what my brand stands for in one sentence
- [ ] I have chosen one signature piece to lead with
- [ ] I know the story of that piece: who makes it, from what, and how long it takes
- [ ] I have photographs of my pieces in finished, real rooms
- [ ] I have close-ups of the material, the finish and the craft
- [ ] I have one or two photographs of the making, in the workshop
- [ ] I have a good portrait of the founder or the founding team
- [ ] I have the original, full-size files, not WhatsApp copies
- [ ] Architects or homeowners have agreed, in writing, to their projects being shown
- [ ] I have written the 150-word story on the next page
- [ ] There is no discount or sale language anywhere in what I send
- [ ] I know which edition I am aiming for, and its closing date

WORKSHEET

Your brand in 150 words

Editors write the story, but they need the facts from you. Fill this in and you have everything they need, in one place.

The piece you want to lead with

Who makes it, and where

The material, and where it comes from

How long one piece takes to make

A home or project it went into (With permission)

Architects or designers who have specified you (With permission)

Why it costs what it costs

MAKE IT COUNT

After it is published

A feature is not a one-day event. Here is how brands make one feature work for the whole year.

Send it to the architects you work with

With a short note. It reminds them of you when they plan their next project.

Put it in your showroom

A copy on the table, or the cover framed on the wall. Visitors notice.

Add it to your website

Show the pages themselves under "As seen in", not just a logo.

Take it to trade fairs

A feature on your stand tells visitors you are worth a longer conversation.

Use it in proposals

For hotels, developers and large projects, a feature shows the work is proven.

Plan the next collection

A feature for each new collection keeps your name in front of the same readers.



Lumiere by Imperial lighting, from its Sylph feature.



A table set with Mia Cara, from its Sylph feature.

FROM RECENT EDITIONS

What a Sylph brand feature looks like



The cover: Progetto's Sanidhya Jain.



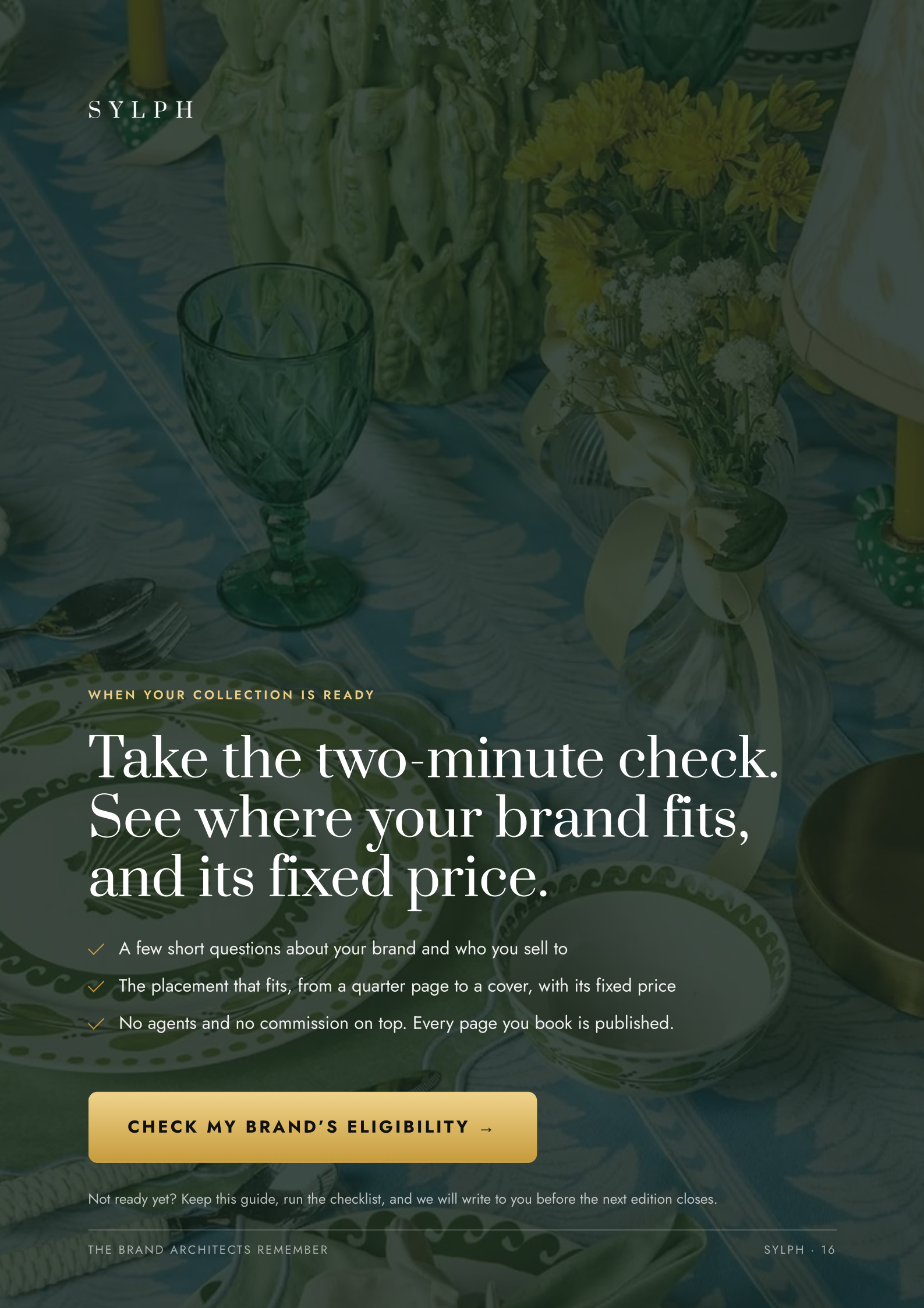
The edition: Kathgodown's Collector's Edition.



The feature: "The Italian Supremacy of Progetto".



The cover: Sarita Handa's interview for Sylph.



WHEN YOUR COLLECTION IS READY

Take the two-minute check. See where your brand fits, and its fixed price.

- A few short questions about your brand and who you sell to
- The placement that fits, from a quarter page to a cover, with its fixed price
- No agents and no commission on top. Every page you book is published.

CHECK MY BRAND'S ELIGIBILITY →

Not ready yet? Keep this guide, run the checklist, and we will write to you before the next edition closes.